

Inline versus block

The identity $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$ sits right in the run of text, at the same size as the words around it. Nothing touches the dollar signs, so Typst keeps the math inline.

Put a space just inside each dollar sign and the same equation lifts out of the paragraph, centered on its own line:

$$a^2 + b^2 = c^2$$

That is the whole rule. A long expression such as $\sum_{i=1}^n i = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}$ stays compact and side-set when it is inline; the very same source, set off as a block, is given room to breathe:

$$\sum_{i=1}^n i = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}$$